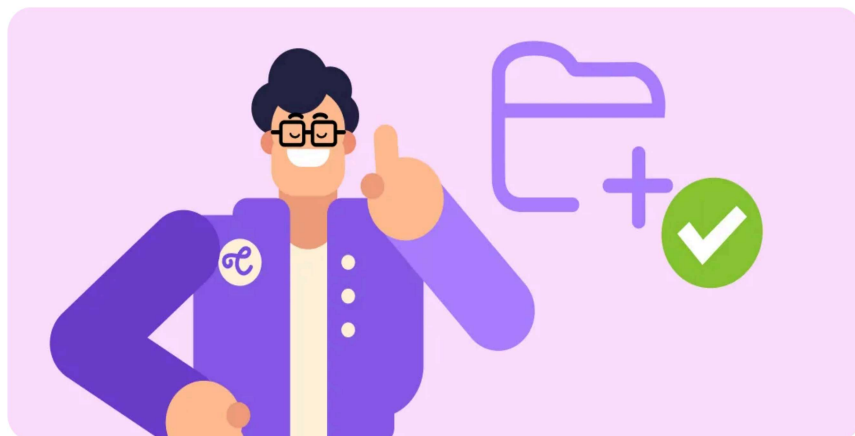
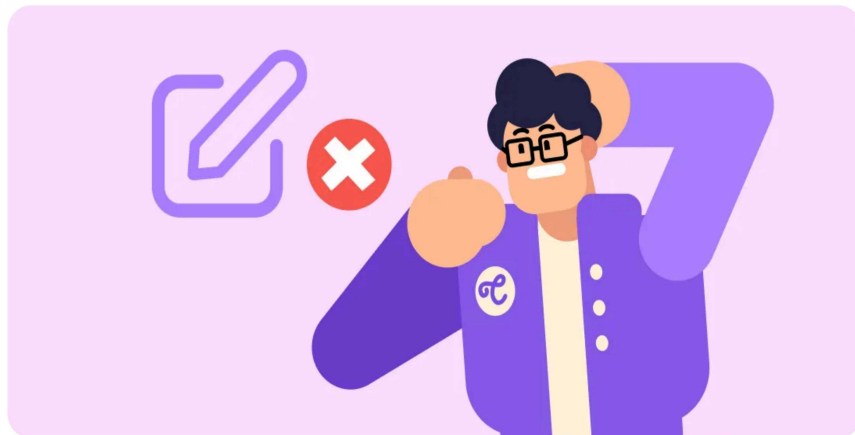


What Are Projects & Why Use Them

Are you using ChatGPT by clicking that little "New Chat" button every time? There's actually a smarter way to keep your work organized, *especially for longer tasks that include planning!*

With **Projects**, instead of dealing with ChatGPT losing track of what you discussed in separate chats, you can keep everything about a task or idea in one spot.



Scenario: Heavy Planning

Let's look at this case: your child's birthday is in three weeks, and you want to use ChatGPT to plan the event. You have:

- A guest list in Excel
- Venue quotes in your email
- Theme inspiration screenshots on your phone
- A dozen text threads with your co-parent about the budget

With so many inputs, you definitely need to develop a multi-step plan.

ChatGPT can help you. But with all the information being scattered, it could be quite difficult.

What do you think is the biggest challenge when using separate ChatGPT chats for multi-step planning?

- ☐ ChatGPT can't handle complex tasks in regular chats
- ☐ Regular chats don't save your conversation history

You have to re-explain the context and re-upload files every time you start a new chat

Correct answer

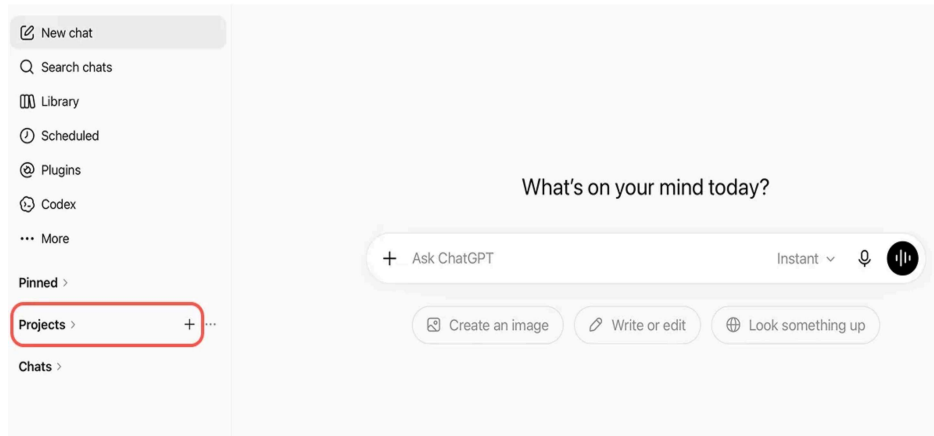
Regular chats work fine, but they don't retain your uploads or context across conversations. For ongoing projects, that means constant repetition.

Your Persistent Workspace

Projects solve this by creating a dedicated space where ChatGPT remembers your progress, stores your files, and follows your specific instructions — across

multiple conversations.

To start a new project, click "+" next to **Projects** to create a workspace and give it a name.

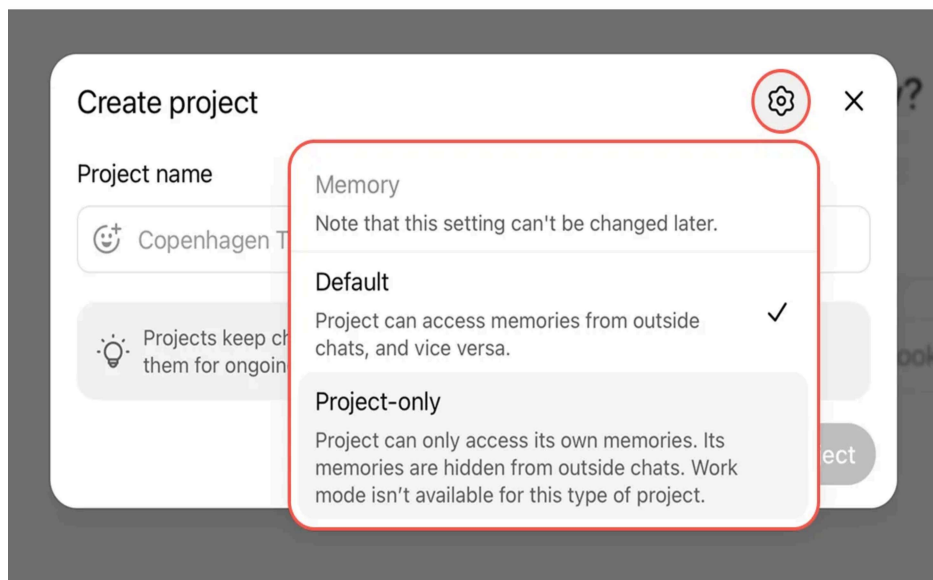


One Setting to Check First

Before you hit Create, click the **gear icon**. It holds one important choice: how your project handles **Memory**.

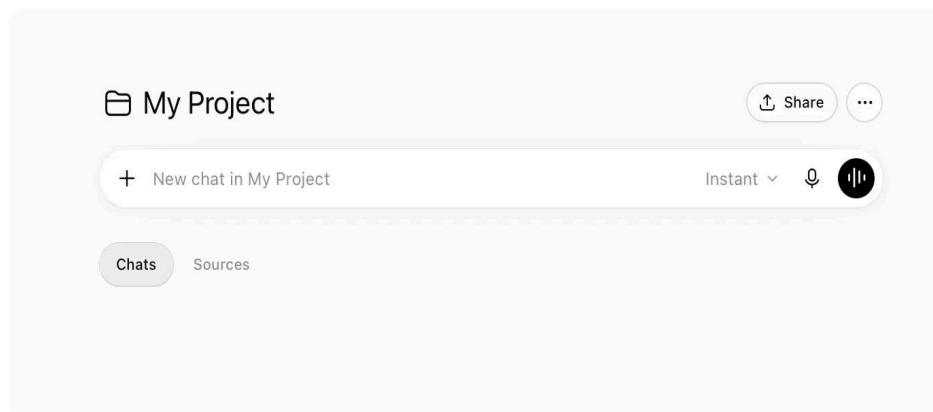
- **Default:** ChatGPT brings what it knows about you into the project and remembers what happens here in your other chats.
- **Project-only:** Pick this when the work needs its own space — nothing leaks in, nothing leaks out.

Choose carefully — this setting can't be changed after the project is created.



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Once your first project is created, what do you think is the primary step that you need to take?



☐ Upload all your files first, and then start chatting

☐ Set instructions for how ChatGPT should respond

☒ **Correct answer**

Instructions tell ChatGPT your goals, tone, and constraints for this specific project. Once set, every chat follows these guidelines automatically.

Setting Project Instructions

Instructions live in **Project settings** — a dedicated field where you describe how ChatGPT should respond in every chat within this project. For example, include:

- Tone
- Constraints
- Priorities
- Rules

You can also set instructions by typing them in the prompt field. Let's try it in the following exercise!

Project settings ×

Project name

My Project

Instructions
Set context and customize how ChatGPT responds in this project.

You are assisting in planning a party for an 8-year-old's birthday. Keep the budget under \$1000. Tone should be fun, warm, and practical. Remember these instructions for next tasks.

Memory

Default

Project can access memories from outside chats, and vice versa. This cannot be changed.

Library access

Enabled ▾

This project can access your file library while it remains private. Sharing this project disables library access.

Delete project

Cancel **Save**

✓ Task completed

Writing Project Instructions

Complete the prompt to see how you can set instructions for your project.

 Repeat task

Great! From now on, every chat in this project will follow these guidelines.

That is, ChatGPT will automatically consider age, budget, and tone without having to repeat them.



What's important is that this isn't just about planning birthday parties.

The prompt you completed can be used as a **template** to plan any other project!

First Discovery

Setting instructions transforms your project into a focused workspace. The same principle works for any goal:

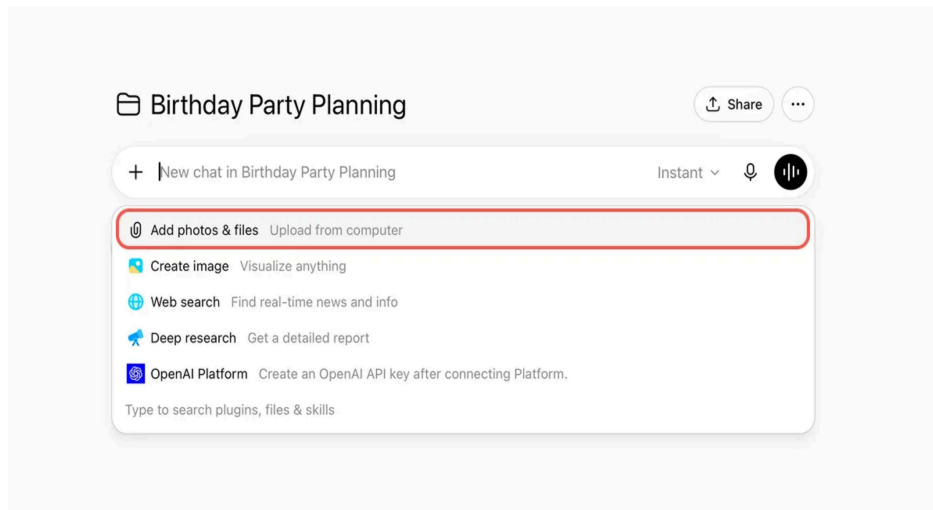
- **Project planning:** *"Keep timelines realistic and highlight risks."*
- **Work tasks:** *"Use professional tone, cite sources."*
- **Learning new skills:** *"Explain like I'm a beginner, use simple examples."*

Instructions eliminate repetitive prompting and keep ChatGPT aligned with your needs.

Uploading Your Party Planning Files

Now comes the powerful part — uploading all your party planning materials to your project.

Click **Add photos & files** — ChatGPT will process and reference everything from guest lists to theme inspirations in any conversation within this project.



Coursiv

For example, imagine you have these files for your party:

- **Excel sheet** of guests with names, dietary restrictions, and RSVP status
- **PDF document** of three venue options with pricing
- **Pinterest screenshots** of unicorn theme ideas

Once uploaded, you can use this information in your project without re-uploading it each time.

What do you think ChatGPT can do with the party-planning files you uploaded?

Select all possible answers

Create a budget based on venue quotes

Share the files with vendors automatically

Count guests and identify dietary restrictions from the Excel file

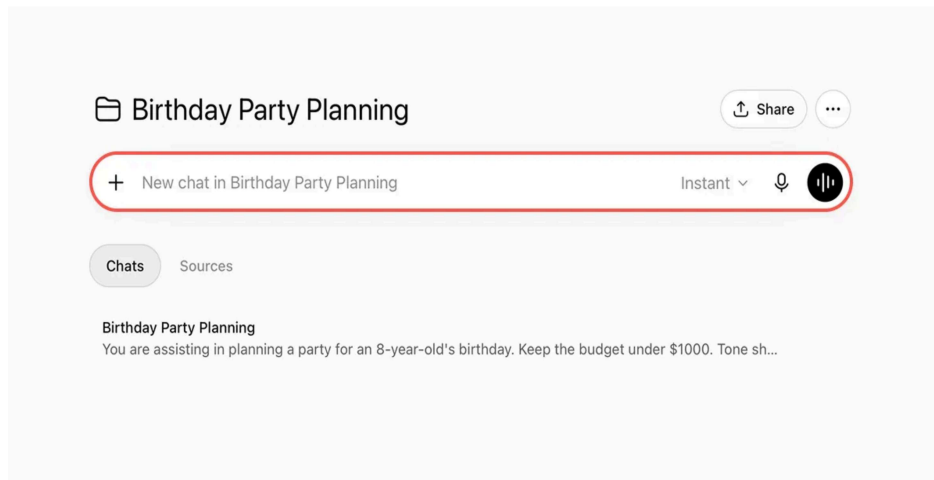
Suggest decoration ideas that match your theme inspiration

✗ Incorrect answer

ChatGPT doesn't share files externally or contact vendors. But it can read your uploads and use them to build budgets, timelines, and task lists.

To do exactly that, start a chat and prompt ChatGPT to use the data you need.

This is the part when you start working with ChatGPT directly through prompting.



Within your project, you can start as many chats as you wish. But what would be the best approach?

Use each chat for one specific purpose

Keep everything in a single chat thread

☐ Start new chats whenever you have questions

✗ Incorrect answer

Single threads get messy fast, and random chats create chaos. Strategic chat organization — one purpose per chat — keeps your project navigable and efficient.

✓ Task completed

Using Uploaded Files

Complete the prompt to start a chat for budgeting purposes.

 Repeat task

See? You did not need to attach your files again.

Instead, ChatGPT just instantly understood the context and organized specific pricing from the PDF into a complete budget.

Second Discovery

Instructions and files function as *working memory* for your project. Just like you created a budget chat, you can start dedicated chats for:

- **Timeline planning:** *"Create week-by-week tasks leading to party day".*
- **Guest management:** *"Track RSVPs and dietary restrictions."*
- **Shopping lists:** *"Organize decoration purchases by store."*
- **Day-of coordination:** *"Build a minute-by-minute party day schedule."*

Each chat uses the same files and instructions — no repetition needed.

So far, we have only covered how to use Projects for planning events. But can this feature be used for other purposes?

☐ No, Projects are specifically designed for a limited number of cases only

Yes, Projects work for any multi-step task with ongoing context

✔ Correct answer

Projects shine anywhere you need persistent context — trip planning, business development, learning new skills, home renovations, and content creation. The structure is the same: instructions + files + organized chats.

Using Projects for Different Purposes

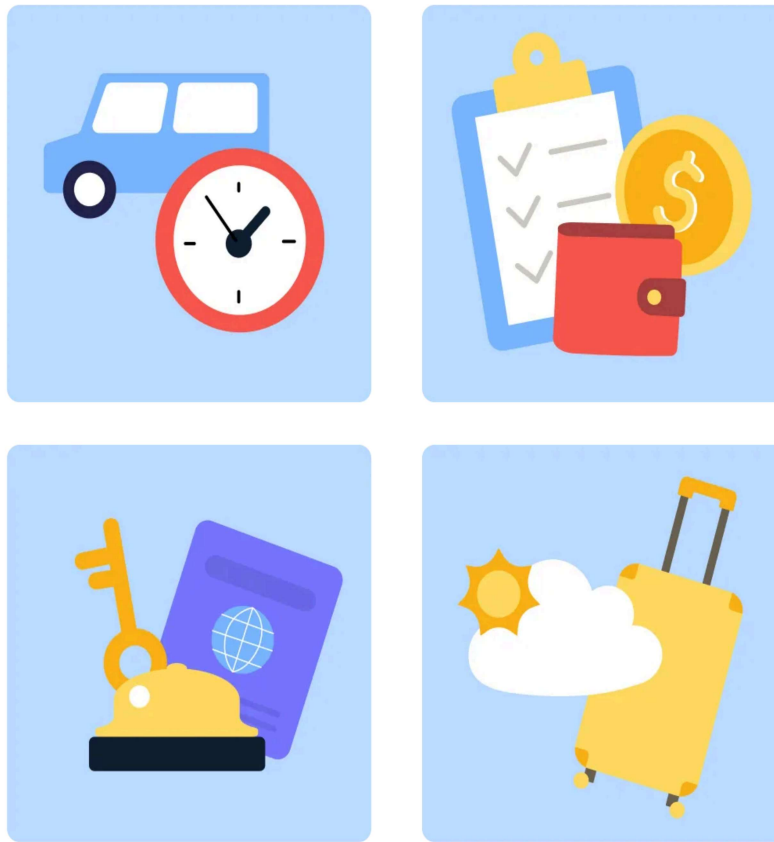
Indeed, this feature can be used for various purposes, including work, hobbies, travel, events, learning, routine planning, and many more.

Let's look at some of these potential applications.

For example, if you're **planning a trip to Iceland**, you can have a project with chats dedicated to:

- **Itinerary building:** daily plans with timing and transportation
- **Budget tracking:** flight, accommodation, food, activities
- **Reservation management:** hotels, restaurants, train passes
- **Packing lists:** climate-appropriate clothing and essentials

Upload flight confirmations, hotel bookings, and inspiration images — ChatGPT references them across all planning chats.



Or, if you're **developing your business's social media with ChatGPT**, you can separate project chats for:

- **Content calendar:** monthly themes and posting schedule
- **Caption writing:** platform-specific posts (Instagram, LinkedIn, Facebook)
- **Visual concepts:** image generation prompts for graphics
- **Performance analysis:** reviewing what content works best

Upload brand guidelines and past successful posts — ChatGPT maintains a consistent voice and style.



Another example: if you're **managing a freelance consulting business**, your project could include chats for:

- **Proposal writing:** client-specific service proposals
- **Project tracking:** deliverables, deadlines, client communication
- **Invoice generation:** monthly billing with hours and expenses
- **Marketing materials:** case studies, testimonials, service descriptions

Upload client contracts and past proposals —
ChatGPT adapts templates to new opportunities while maintaining professionalism.



The pattern is clear: Projects work best when you have multiple related tasks that share common context — files, goals, tone, and constraints.

Whether planning events, managing work, or learning skills, the structure remains the same: set instructions, upload materials, and organize chats by purpose.

✓ Task completed

Working Efficiently in Projects

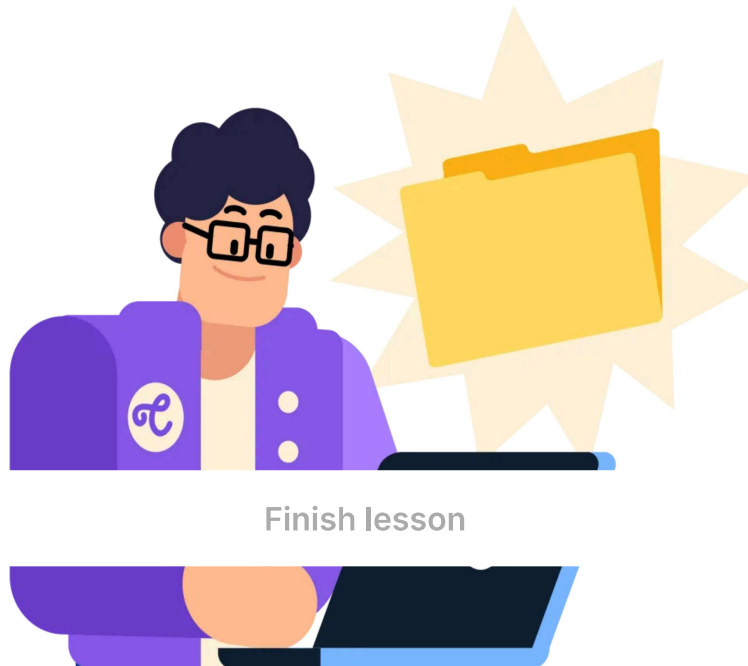
Now, arrange the steps of working in Projects to solidify this knowledge.

 Repeat task

Excellent Work!

You've learned how Projects create persistent workspaces where files, instructions, and context stay connected across conversations.

This is powerful for multi-step planning — events, trips, business development — where decisions build on each other over time.



Key Takeaways

- **Projects** keep files and instructions available across multiple chats within a single workspace.
- **Set instructions once** to define tone, constraints, and goals for the entire project.
- **Organize work** by creating dedicated chats for specific purposes.
- Projects **work best for multi-step tasks** where context builds over time.

What's Next?

Now that you understand Projects, the next lesson introduces **Custom GPTs** — reusable AI assistants that you build yourself.

Ready to customize your AI? Let's go!

